

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · COUNTRY SERIES

AUSTRALIA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Australia's family courts and child-welfare system.

30

AUSTRALIA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 49 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 26 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

REGIONS REPRESENTED
20

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

AUSTRALIA AT A GLANCE.

Across 30 Australia families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
49
30 of 30 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$539,000
median across 16 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
26
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
56.7%
17 of 30 who answered; 22 of 30 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	REGIONS REPRESENTED
30	1.6	30 of 30	20

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Australia families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

02 THE COST OF AUSTRALIA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	20	$90,000	$151,455	$3,029,100
Lost Wages	15	$100,000	$410,000	$6,150,000
Other Court Fees	7	$10,000	$19,714	$138,000
Therapy / Evaluations	11	$4,000	$48,636	$535,000
Reunification Services	7	$2,000	$4,964	$34,750
GAL Fees	4	$2,250	$8,625	$34,500
Asset Loss	11	$500,000	$1,280,364	$14,084,000
Median Family Burden (16 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	**$539,000**	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



03 WHO IS REPORTING · AUSTRALIA

Most families documenting in Australia are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	17	57%
Case closed: within last 2 years	6	20%
Not in court but still affected	5	17%
Active case: progress being made	1	3%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	1	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only	15	50%
Both Family Court and CPS	11	37%
CPS Only	4	13%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	11	37%
3 – 5 years	8	27%
5 – 10 years	5	17%
6 months – 1 year	4	13%
Less than 6 months	1	3%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	14	47%
Visitation Only	6	20%
Children in Foster Care	4	13%
Full Custody	4	13%
50/50 Joint	2	7%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP REGIONS

Queensland	6	20%
Victoria	3	10%
Nsw	2	7%
Geelong, Victoria	2	7%
New South Wales	2	7%
Naw	1	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	15	50%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	7	23%
Other	4	13%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)	2	7%
High Conflict Divorce	1	3%

04 PARENT VOICES — AUSTRALIA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Australia comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *My children and myself we being domestically abused by my ex partner. I contacted local police in Melbourne, Victoria and then CPS. There was no investigation, my ex partner made false allegations which stopped me from seeing my children for 4 months. Family Law is a complete [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

My children have been given into the sole care of their father whom they disclosed abused them physically, psychologically and sexually, with an active police investigation on foot which the judge was aware of and disregarded. Children both have ND diagnoses. One has gender [...]

— AUSTRALIA PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM AUSTRALIA

The system has totally destroyed me and my children over false accusations my daughter has gone with inside herself I believe that CPS uses the same tactics as domestic violence to destroy families and children's lives I have missed it so much time with my child that I will [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

In Australia, Dv side, a corrupt system designed to destroy (mostly) men. Family law- corrupt system deaigned for judges, lawyers, and court players to profit parents, "Cash for kids", where men are automatically discriminated

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"I survived grief, trauma, and the challenges of raising a medically complex child, but what broke me was a system that watched my relationship with my children disappear in slow motion and no one did nothing to stop it."

— JESSICA-LEE

Being a Christian in Australia - this has been the cost - sorrow, pain, suffering and bring false witnessed as a bad mother when God has provided my babies to me and God has blessed our marriage and it is God's mandate to be fruitful and multiply. It is God who says "do not stop [...]

— HEPHZIBAH

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *My children were abused emotionally, physically and sexually. The system kept sending them to their abuser and wouldn't listen.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Child silenced Mother silenced Child given to her abuser

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Parental alienation is real and the courts don't recognise this as coercive control nor child abuse, children are lost in an abusive system and targeted parents suffer and grieve the loss of a living child.

— NATALIE

Breaking my heart everyday that I'm not with my kids.

— BRIELLE

Completely destroyed my life with my children and have left the in an imprisoned environment they have precisely voiced their wishes to be with their father. My son does not attend school at all ruining his future prospects

— DANE

Family Court is a legalized crime syndicate that destroy families and vilifies dads. It doesn't need evidence.

— PETER

Completely destroyed our sense of safety and security, financially impoverished me and i have ptsd as a result of the dv.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have no faith for victims getting justices just constant contact with courts to try and feel safe only to be Victimsed and ignored

— CLOEY

This has cost so much time my children and I can never get back. It has put me back about 15-20 years worth or work. Now I need to try to navigate a way out, so the kids are as least affected as possible. All because I finally saw through her manipulation tactics.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Unhealed trauma from coercion, institutional betrayal, destroyed child, completely subotaged children's primal attachment systems, destroyed my multimillion $ equity and my health. Oldest child is disabled after 3 years in a hospital on return from being kidnapped. Made me [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

They stole my daughter,using deliberate fabrications to set me up so they can hand her to her paedophile father

— ELIZABETH

It is obviously a scam from start to finish. My court documents could easily demonstrate this. The registrar told me to my face that "I have to pay if I ever want to see my children again". The Judge at final 'Trial' held a hearing without letting me in the room, then left [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Denied access to my children even supervised access due to my ex not agreeing so judge wouldn't enforce time unless he agreed before a final hearing as apparently they can only sign off on what we agree on. Court cases dragged out for very extended periods of time until a "date [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has completely dismantled my 20-year career by handing my business over to the perpetrator, while leaving me with complex PTSD and my family financially and emotionally depleted. Most destructively, it ignored historical evidence to place a vulnerable [...]

— LILIAN

My ex formed a relationship with the police officer who put a false violence order on me. Created many false allegations that i had ti defend, but the ex had police prosecutor on her side because police kept making charges, but 9 out of 10 charges were eventually dismissed [...]

— ANDREW

"What should have been a process to protect families instead left us exhausted, financially devastated, and emotionally broken. The damage from the court process lasted far beyond the courtroom."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *The system took everything I built over 20 years, removed me from my daughter's life when she was 10 years old, and used a single moment of a desperate father's distress — after months of being denied access to his child — to define me as a person not worth knowing, all through [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

23 Australia parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 23 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — AUSTRALIA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Australia families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> My children have been given into the sole care of their father whom they disclosed abused them physically, psychologically and sexually, with an active police investigation on foot which the judge was aware of and disregarded. Children both have ND diagnoses. One has gender dysphoria. Father immediately engaged in gender identity suppression and forced trans daughter into male clothes and cut her hair. Children were both suicidal at return to father. I was at hospital with children when judge set down orders and put in a recovery order. My daughter had to be taken by ambulance. I could not be there. I was accused of multiple false harms to my children. They engaged in ex parte actions when the judge knew a medical emergency prevented me from being at court. I am permitted no contact with my children. Despite alienation being rejected, it being stated that I did not alienate, and the reunification therapist giving evidence the children said the father tortured them, the judge sent them back and allowed the father to release her judgment to help him avoid investigation and ensure no one would believe the children.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> My children and myself we being domestically abused by my ex partner. I contacted local police in Melbourne, Victoria and then CPS. There was no investigation, my ex partner made false allegations which stopped me from seeing my children for 4 months. Family Law is a complete scam as I have had everything stolen from my life because I tried to protect my child.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system has totally destroyed me and my children over false accusations my daughter has gone with inside herself I believe that CPS uses the same tactics as domestic violence to destroy families and children's lives I have missed it so much time with my child that I will never get back again family services that don't borderline on abuse they are abuse with their lawyers manipulation tactics divide and conquer coercive controlling and mental abuse as I believe family services should be eradicated and the child protectional unit on the police force should step up and do their job because family services only are there to destroy families not to help them as shown those system of support they don't believe in reuniteification they only believe in destroying and disrupting the parent and the child'
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> In Australia, Dv side, a corrupt system designed to destroy (mostly) men. Family law- corrupt system deaigned for judges, lawyers, and court players to profit parents, "Cash for kids", where men are automatically discriminated
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

"I survived grief, trauma, and the challenges of raising a medically complex child, but what broke me was a system that watched my relationship with my children disappear in slow motion and no one did nothing to stop it."

— JESSICA-LEE

Being a Christian in Australia - this has been the cost - sorrow, pain, suffering and bring false witnessed as a bad mother when God has provided my babies to me and God has blessed our marriage and it is God's mandate to be fruitful and multiply. It is God who says "do not stop the little children from coming to me", yet it is to separate my children from Christ that the anti-Christian, anti-God government of New South Wales in Australia has removed my previous babies. Their documentation is replete with lies and omissions specifically against our belief in Jesus Christ and this spouted by their judges in court, at final hearing to remove two babies from their innocent parents for 18 years with no evidence of harm by us.

— HEPHZIBAH

My children were abused emotionally, physically and sexually. The system kept sending them to their abuser and wouldn't listen.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Child silenced Mother silenced Child given to her abuser

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Parental alienation is real and the courts don't recognise this as coercive control nor child abuse, children are lost in an abusive system and targeted parents suffer and grieve the loss of a living child.

— NATALIE

Breaking my heart everyday that I'm not with my kids.

— BRIELLE

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Completely destroyed my life with my children and have left the in an imprisoned environment they have precisely voiced their wishes to be with their father. My son does not attend school at all ruining his future prospects

— DANE

Family Court is a legalized crime syndicate that destroy families and vilifies dads. It doesn't need evidence.

— PETER

Completely destroyed our sense of safety and security, financially impoverished me and i have ptsd as a result of the dv.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have no faith for victims getting justices just constant contact with courts to try and feel safe only to be Victimsed and ignored

— CLOEY

This has cost so much time my children and I can never get back. It has put me back about 15-20 years worth or work. Now I need to try to navigate a way out, so the kids are as least affected as possible. All because I finally saw through her manipulation tactics.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Unhealed trauma from coercion, institutional betrayal, destroyed child, completely subotaged children's primal attachment systems, destroyed my multimillion $ equity and my health. Oldest child is disabled after 3 years in a hospital on return from being kidnapped. Made me homeless with a small underage child. Destroyed my business.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They stole my daughter,using deliberate fabrications to set me up so they can hand her to her paedophile father

— ELIZABETH

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It is obviously a scam from start to finish. My court documents could easily demonstrate this. The registrar told me to my face that "I have to pay if I ever want to see my children again". The Judge at final 'Trial' held a hearing without letting me in the room, then left without providing a reason. It has been officially called a hearing, it was organised crime.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Denied access to my children even supervised access due to my ex not agreeing so judge wouldn't enforce time unless he agreed before a final hearing as apparently they can only sign off on what we agree on. Court cases dragged out for very extended periods of time until a "date was available" final hearing coming up after 2 and a half years. Psychiatrist court ordered deemed me as bipolar when this is an incorrect diagnosis. Family report writer said my ex should have full custody due to me not taking medication for "bipolar".

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has completely dismantled my 20-year career by handing my business over to the perpetrator, while leaving me with complex PTSD and my family financially and emotionally depleted. Most destructively, it ignored historical evidence to place a vulnerable child back into the full control of their abuser, forcing the revictimization of my son under the guise of justice.

— LILIAN

My ex formed a relationship with the police officer who put a false violence order on me. Created many false allegations that i had ti defend, but the ex had police prosecutor on her side because police kept making charges, but 9 out of 10 charges were eventually dismissed because lack of evidence and support, or she simply didnt turn up to defend allegations, but i had to pay ongoing solicitors and self represent at times.

— ANDREW

"What should have been a process to protect families instead left us exhausted, financially devastated, and emotionally broken. The damage from the court process lasted far beyond the courtroom."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> The system took everything I built over 20 years, removed me from my daughter's life when she was 10 years old, and used a single moment of a desperate father's distress — after months of being denied access to his child — to define me as a person not worth knowing, all through proceedings conducted by officers who cannot be shown to have held lawful authority to do any of it.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

23 full approved Australia comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Australia report comes from Australia respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Australia — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 30 Australia families reporting here are not the universe of Australia families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

STANDWITHMEG.COM | COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE.